Kifekachukwu Nwosu

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EDUCATION

Rochester Institute of Technology (RIT) — Rochester, NY

B.S. Computer Science, GPA: 3.3 | Expected May 2027

B.S. Women, Gender & Sexuality Studies

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, C, C++, C#, SQL, JavaScript, HTML/CSS

Frameworks/Tools: Angular, Spring Boot, REST API, JUnit, JavaFX, Unity, Figma, Git/GitHub

Data & ML: PyTorch, Hugging Face/Transformers, Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, Matrix Profiling

WORK EXPERIENCE

CRA-DREU Fellow — Lab for Population Intelligence, RIT *Summer 2026 – Present*

Rochester, NY

- Built an evaluation pipeline to test zero-shot classification (BART-large-MNLI, Hugging Face) against a human-coded reference set of 500 hand-annotated tweets, drawn from a 13,000+ tweet #EndSARS dataset
- Measured model performance using precision, recall, F1-score, Cohen's kappa, and AUC; ran threshold-tuning experiments to diagnose sources of model-human disagreement
- Applied NLP and Framing Theory to analyze how the #EndSARS movement was framed on Twitter, surfacing model limitations on culturally-specific language (Nigerian Pidgin, sarcasm, context-dependent phrasing)

Machine Learning Research Engineer — MDATA Lab, UMBC *June 2023 – January 2025*

Baltimore, MD

- Built and shipped unsupervised ML algorithms to detect anomalies in audio time-series data, with results published in 4 peer-reviewed papers (IEEE, AAAI, LSA)
- Engineered end-to-end Python data pipelines (Pandas, NumPy, PyTorch) for cleaning, feature extraction, and model training at scale
- Built auto-annotation tooling to tag audio clips with linguistic features and integrated Expert-Defined Linguistic Features (EDLFs) to improve deepfake-detection accuracy and interpretability

Undergraduate Researcher — Golisano College of Computing, RIT *Summer 2024*

Rochester, NY

- Designed high-fidelity mockups in Figma to prototype accessible UI features for gaming platforms, targeting players with disabilities
- Conducted usability studies on prototype designs and presented findings to faculty, informing ongoing accessibility research initiatives

PROJECTS

HeartStrings — Crowdfunding Platform *Java, Angular, REST API, JUnit, MySQL, PostgreSQL*

- Built a full-stack web application connecting underserved communities with music lessons and instruments through crowdfunded campaigns
- Implemented user authentication, enabling users to securely log in and manage a personal funding basket
- Built manager tools to add, edit, and remove funding needs (Angular front end, Java Spring APIs)

Fresh'n Out — 3D Adventure Game *C#, Unity*

- Served as Scrum Master for a cross-functional team of 8, running sprint planning, standups, and retrospectives to keep development on schedule
- Engineered core gameplay systems, including player movement and interaction mechanics

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Auto Annotation of Linguistic Features for Audio Deepfake Discernment — AAAI Fall Symposium (First Author)
- Spoofed Audio Detection through Linguistic Data Augmentation — IEEE ISI 2023 (Co-Author)

HONORS & AWARDS

- Larsen-Brownell Scholarship; Communication and Ethics Award; Student Beacon Award; First Prize, RIT WGSS Symposium (all 2026)

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

- Vice President, ALANA Collegiate Association, RIT Student Government (Fall 2025 – Present)
- President, Organization of African Students, RIT (Fall 2024 – Spring 2025); McNair Scholars Program Fellow